

Lauren Beatty

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Appointments

2025-Present Economist, **Environmental Defense Fund**
2023-2025 Highmeadows Postdoctoral Economics Fellow, **Environmental Defense Fund**

Education

2023 PhD, Agricultural and Resource Economics, **University of Maryland**
Dissertation Committee: Josh Linn (chair), James Archsmith, Louis Preonas, Rob Williams, Andrew Sweeting

2016 BA, Math and Economics, **Macalester College**

Working Papers

Pricing the Social Cost of Flaring: Composition, Location, and Policy Implications. (With Mark Agerton, Wesley Blundell, Ben Gilbert and Sophia Salzer). <https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.6313938>

Pipelines, Drilling, and Environmental Externalities: Insights from a Dynamic Model of Natural Gas Flaring (Available Upon Request)

Works in Progress

Cleanup Delay and Second-Best Environmental Policy: Structural Estimates from Texas Oil & Gas Wells (With Mark Agerton and Diógenes)

Learning about Greenhouse Gas Emissions from Atmospheric Inversion Data: Insights from MethaneSAT (With Ben Gilbert and Eric Lewis)

Permanent Working Papers

How Do Natural Gas Pipeline Networks Affect Emissions From Drilling and Flaring? [Link](#)

Other Writing

"The Hidden Price Tag of Flaring: Why Burning Off Natural Gas Costs Society Billions" (With Mark Agerton and Sophia Salzer) *EDF Market Forces Blog* (March 2026)

"Clearing the Air: How New Rules for Oil & Gas Facilities Offer Major Wins for the Environment and Economy" (With Aaron Wolfe) *EDF Market Forces Blog* (June 2024)

"Louisiana's Inactive Wells: Steps Toward Improved Management" (With Aaron Wolfe, Margaret Coleman, Maureen Lackner and Adam Peltz) *Environmental Defense Fund Economics Discussion Paper Series*, [http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5044308](https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5044308) (December, 2024)

"How Economists Can Leverage MethaneSAT Data for Climate Action" (With Maureen Lackner) *EDF Market Forces Blog* (March 2024)

Fellowships and Awards

2021-2023	NBER Pre-Doctoral Fellowship in Energy Economics
2020	Bessie H. DeVault Award for Best Paper by a Third-Year Student
2018	Rhona Lantin Memorial Scholarship for Best Paper by a First-Year Student
2017-2022	University of Maryland Flagship Fellowship
2016	Phi Beta Kappa
2016	3M Scholar Award
2015	John M. Dozier Prize in Economics

Pre-Doctoral Employment

Graduate Research Assistant for James Archsmith	Aug. 2022 - May 2023
Graduate Research Assistant for Louis Preonas	Aug. 2019 - Aug. 2021
Graduate Teaching Assistant for AREC 610 (Applied Microeconomics)	Jan. 2019-May 2019
Graduate Teaching Assistant for AREC 623 (Econometrics I)	Sep. 2018-Jan. 2019
Graduate Research Assistant for Anna Alberini	Jan. 2018-Sep. 2018
Graduate Research Assistant for Robertson Williams III	Sep. 2017-Dec. 2017
Abstract Algebra Preceptor	Jan. 2016 - Jun. 2016
Multivariable Calculus Preceptor	Sep. 2014 - Dec. 2014
Discrete Mathematics Preceptor	Sep. 2013 - Jun. 2014

Presentations

2025 WEAI Summer Conference; AAEA Summer Conference **2024**: AERE Summer Conference; University of Calgary Fireside Conversation **2023**: AERE Summer Conference; Wesleyan University, Department of Economics; U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, National Center for Environmental Economics; New England ISO; Federal Trade Commission; Department of Justice; Government Accountability Office

Professional Activities

Reviewing: Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Energy Policy, Environmental Science and Technology, Nature Communications

References

Josh Linn:	linn@umd.edu
Rob Williams:	roberton@umd.edu
Louis Preonas:	lpreonas@umd.edu
James Archsmith:	archsmit@umd.edu

Skills

R, Python, SQL, Git, Stata, L^AT_EX